

Notaden bennettii

Holy cross toad



Length 1½–2¼ in (4–7 cm)
Habit Mostly terrestrial
Breeding After heavy rain
season rain
Status Least concern

Location E. Australia



Named after the crosslike pattern of warts on its back, this small, globular toad belongs to a family of over 43 species that are found only in Australia. Like many of its relatives, it spends dry periods underground,

and emerges to feed and breed when it rains. This toad feeds on ants and termites, and produces a sticky, defensive secretion when handled. Its tadpoles develop in temporary pools.



short, stumpy legs

Crinia insignifera

Sign-bearing toadlet



Length ½–1¼ in (1.5–3 cm)
Habit Mostly terrestrial
Breeding Winter season
season winter
Status Least concern

Location S.W. Australia



The sign-bearing toadlet is a small Australian frog with a slender body and limbs. It is gray to brown, and often has a dark triangular patch between its eyes; its skin may be smooth or warty. This frog inhabits

temporary swamps that form after winter rain, preying on insects and other invertebrates, and spends dry periods underground. During the breeding season, the male calls to attract a mate. Females lay about 60–250 eggs at a time in water, either singly or in clumps; the eggs fall to the bottom of the pond.



darker spots or stripes

long digits

Mixophyes carbinensis

Carbine frog



Length 2¼–3 in (6–7.5 cm)
Habit Mostly terrestrial
Breeding Spring and summer
season spring and summer
Status Least concern

Location N.E. Australia



This species was described in 2006 on the basis of specimens collected from Mount Lewis in the Carbine highlands of Queensland—in an area designated as a World Heritage Site. It belongs to a genus of large ground-dwelling frogs restricted to eastern Australia and New Guinea, and lives in montane rain forest near streams and pools. Males call during the breeding season from the leaf-litter floor.

Pseudophryne corroboree

Corroboree frog



Length 1–1¼ in (2.5–3 cm)
Habit Mostly terrestrial
Breeding Summer season
season summer
Status Critically endangered

Location Australia (S.E. New South Wales)



This critically endangered animal, also known as the corroboree toadlet, is one of Australia's most colorful amphibians. It lives in moss-covered bogs in the Australian Alps, and lays its eggs in the moss rather than in water. The reason for its vivid colors—yellow or yellow-green, with black stripes—is unclear: unlike most brightly colored amphibians, it does not have toxic skin.



short, unwebbed digits

Limnodynastes peronii

Brown-striped frog



Length 1¼–2½ in (3–6.5 cm)
Habit Mostly terrestrial
Breeding Spring and summer
season spring and summer
Status Least concern

Location E. Australia



Also known as the Australian grass frog, this long-limbed amphibian, with dark longitudinal stripes along its body, lives in and around swamps, feeding at night on insects and other invertebrates. During winter and dry spells, it buries itself underground. The male makes a clicklike call to attract

the female. During mating, the pair make a floating foam nest in which 700–1,000 eggs are deposited. The eggs hatch quickly, and the tadpoles develop very rapidly.



powerful hind legs

Uperoleia lithomoda

Stonemason toadlet



Length ½–1¼ in (1.5–3 cm)
Habit Mostly terrestrial
Breeding Winter season
season winter
Status Least concern

Location N. Australia



The clicklike courtship call of this small, squat frog sounds like 2 stones being hit together, hence its name. It is dull brown or gray, with a gold line or row of patches along each side of its body, short limbs, and a horny tubercle on its hind feet that enables it to dig into the soil. It spends dry periods buried underground. The female lays eggs in clumps that fall to the pond floor.



wartlike glands on skin

Sechellophryne gardineri

Gardiner's Seychelles frog



Length ¾–1½ in (1–1.5 cm)
Habit Wholly terrestrial
Breeding Rainy season
season rainy season
Status Endangered

Location Seychelles



This tiny, creamy white to yellowish green frog is notable for its unusual breeding pattern. The eggs, which are laid in clumps on the ground, are guarded by the male and hatch into froglets instead of tadpoles. The froglets crawl onto their father's back and remain there, glued on by mucus, until they have used up their yolk and their legs are fully developed.

Heleophryne purcelli

Cape ghost frog



Length 1¼–2¼ in (3–6 cm)
Habit Mostly aquatic
Breeding Summer season
season summer
Status Least concern

Location Southern Africa (Cape region)



The Cape ghost frog is ideally suited to its aquatic lifestyle. Its long legs and webbed hind feet enable it to swim in fast-flowing streams, and its flattened

toe tips give it a strong grip on slippery rocks and boulders. During the breeding season, males develop tiny spines on their bodies. The tadpoles have large, suckerlike mouths to attach themselves to rocks.



flattened body

green, yellow, or brown coloring with mottling

smooth skin